



YAKUT

IMAGINE THE COLDEST WEATHER you have ever known, then triple it, and you are somewhere near the kinds of temperatures the people in Siberia have to endure. The town of Verkhoyansk lies in the area of the

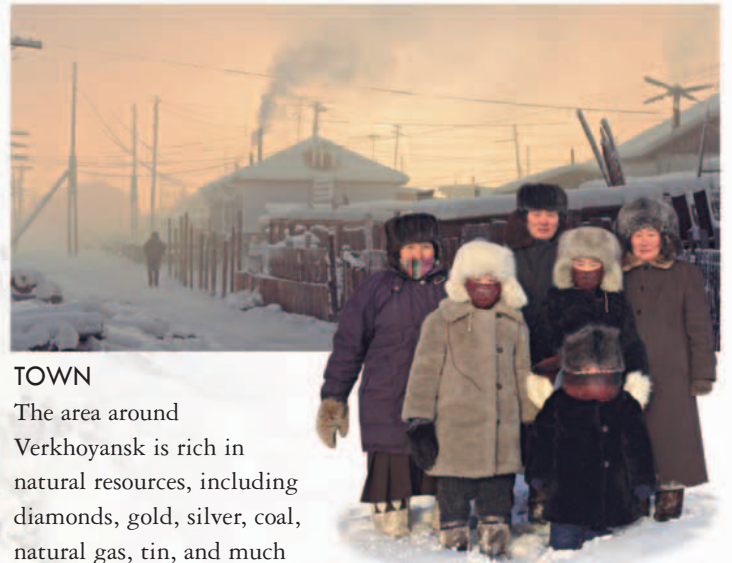
LIFE IN THE WORLD'S COLDEST TOWN

Verkhoyansk

Traditionally, the Yakut way of life revolves around reindeer herding, and also, more unusually in the Arctic, horse and cattle raising. Most Yakut people today are urban dwellers and live in towns like Verkhoyansk. Farming in this area is difficult due to the freezing conditions, however, because of the continental climate, the temperatures do rise in the summer so grass can be made into hay and vegetables can be grown.

HORSE RAISING

The horses that the Yakut use are extremely hardy animals. They have a thick layer of fat and thick fur. They survive the winter on natural pastures without being fed by humans. As well as reindeer fur, the Yakut people also wear horse skins to keep them warm.



TOWN

The area around Verkhoyansk is rich in natural resources, including diamonds, gold, silver, coal, natural gas, tin, and much more. These are a major source of income for the Russian economy, so there is a lot of industry and mining in the area. A lot of the Yakut people have given up their traditional ways to work in industry.

THE BOREAL FOREST

In order for a town to function in such bitterly cold temperatures, enormous amounts of wood have to be burned. Verkhoyansk lies in the vast Boreal forest region of Siberia. Filled with larch and pine trees the forest provides plenty of wood.

